Manu Peethambar

LEAD PRODUCT DESIGNER

AI & agentic experiences · Platforms at scale · 0→1 products · Accessibility

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Lead product designer with 14+ years turning complex, high-stakes systems into simple products people trust. At Amazon, I led design for agentic AI, global self-service, and 0→1 accessibility products used by 1.5M+ users in 55+ countries, taking work from PRFAQ and north-star vision to shipped, measured outcomes. Hands-on, prototyping in Figma and in code.

EXPERIENCE

Amazon — Lead Product Designer

Oct 2021 – Jan 2026

AI assistants, self-service and mobile experiences, and data platforms at global scale

- Designed the interaction model for **AZA**, an AI assistant orchestrating 17+ expert sub-agents across millions of queries in 60 countries; its confirmation loops and human-in-the-loop escalation became the org's agentic UX template.
- Redesigned a high-stakes request workflow with explainable AI (**ALICE** conversational intake and confirm-first document extraction), cutting review time 35–45%, case handling 25–30%, and incomplete submissions 65%.
- Founded and led **Hermes**, 0→1 AI sign-language interpretation for Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing users, from field research to pilots that reached 90%+ meeting accessibility coverage and ~50% higher participation.
- Redesigned a global self-service platform end to end, replacing a legacy third-party system in a 7-month phased rollout: 65K+ profile updates in month one.
- Shifted a native mobile app from reactive status-checking to proactive updates (push, home-screen tiles); a tile answering an SVP escalation cut related contacts ~70%.
- Unified 5+ builder tools in **FPDS**, the data platform behind 9,000+ apps, into one experience with shared privacy and data-access patterns; briefed VPs on the north star.
- Extended **Stencil**, the org's design system, with components and patterns adopted across 10+ AI and enterprise products, born-accessible to WCAG 2.2 AA.
- Mentored 10+ designers; often the sole designer across 10+ product areas and 13+ active initiatives; shaped roadmaps and OP1 priorities via PRFAQs and exec reviews.
- Prototype in code with Claude Code, Cursor, and Figma Make to test interaction concepts early and tighten design-engineering handoff.

UserWorks — User Experience Specialist

May 2019 – Oct 2021

UX research & design consultancy · Clients: USPS.com, BrainScope, MassDOT

- Led research and redesign recommendations for **USPS.com** (2.3B+ annual sessions) through accessibility audits, heuristic evaluations, and usability testing.
- Delivered interaction models, prototypes, and inclusive-design recommendations for healthcare, government, and education clients.

Deloitte — UX Consultant & Product Designer

Mar 2016 – Jan 2018

- Led design for **Straight2Bank**, Standard Chartered's global B2B banking platform; reusable patterns and a design system unlocked ~4,000 hours of productivity.
- Facilitated client workshops and design sprints that aligned stakeholders on product vision and roadmap.

Infosys — Senior UX Designer

Aug 2011 – Mar 2016

- Redesigned Fidelity's **NetBenefits**, lifting customer engagement 35% through clearer IA and pattern-driven UI; led eDelivery and a shared component library.

IMPACT

1.5M+
users across 55+ countries

87%
self-service adoption in the first month

~40%
efficiency gain from AI tools

90%+
accessibility coverage in pilots

EXPERTISE

Product & interaction design
Interaction models, IA, native mobile and web, prototyping, motion

AI & agentic UX
Multi-agent and conversational UX, human-in-the-loop, explainability, trust

Vibe coding & AI prototyping
Working prototypes in real code: Claude Code, Cursor, Figma Make, HTML/CSS/JS

Systems & platforms
Design systems and tokens, platform and data UX, multi-surface patterns

Research & accessibility
Contextual inquiry, usability testing, WCAG 2.2 AA, inclusive design

Leadership
North-star vision, PRFAQs, executive storytelling, mentoring, critique

TOOLS

Figma · Figma Make · Claude Code · Cursor · Sketch · Adobe CC · HTML/CSS/JS

EDUCATION

M.S. Human-Computer Interaction
University of Maryland, Baltimore County (UMBC) · 2019